

A viewer, and what it is for

This document exists so that a viewer can be shown reading something ordinary. It carries no data belonging to anyone, and every line of it is drawn by a script that ships with the package.

Between those two cases sits everything this package has to get right: how a document opens, how far it may be zoomed, which part of it is drawn at what moment, and what is shown in the meantime.

Setting	Value
Opening zoom	fits the width
Zoom ceiling	13 points to the point
Tile size	1280 pixels
Renderers	three at once

What is on the screen is drawn in tiles, at the zoom it is being looked at. Nothing else is drawn. A tile that has left the view before its turn came is dropped rather than drawn, and the one nearest the middle of the view is always drawn first.

A pinch changes the zoom on every frame, and whoever is listening is almost certainly putting the number on the screen. So the zoom is reported a few times a second rather than sixty, and once more when the movement stops.

How a document opens

A page like this one is the case most viewers are built for: a fixed size, a column of text, a heading or two, and a table. It is also the case where a viewer can afford to draw the whole page at once, and where doing so is the quickest thing to do.

A document opens fitted to its width, because a document is read by scrolling and fitting twelve pages on a phone would show twelve stamps. A page that is a strip rather than a page fills the height instead, and is read by panning sideways.

While the tiles of a new zoom are on their way, the levels already held are drawn underneath them, coarsest first. Moving at a deep zoom therefore lands on something drawn on the way in, rather than on a blank rectangle.

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How far it may be zoomed

The sheet in the other document is the case they are not built for. One drawing, nine metres wide, with dimensions written at a size that is a smudge on a phone until the zoom is ten times what the page opened at. Drawing that from one picture of the page means either a line across the middle of the screen or an image too large to hold.

How far a document may be zoomed is not a fixed number of times. It is worked out from the page: far enough in that a point of the page is about thirteen points of the screen, which is where a dimension written along a beam becomes comfortable rather than merely possible.

Tiles are held until the room runs out, oldest use first. Every tile on the screen is read on every frame, so a tile being looked at can never be the one thrown away to make room for its neighbour.

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What is drawn, and when

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What is shown in the meantime

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Two platforms, one set of numbers

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What a tile costs

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Holding what has been drawn

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How often an event is worth sending

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Where this document came from

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